Mars (M&M) – US Field Sales Program Guidelines & Commercial Principles

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Region: United States

Business Unit: Mars Wrigley – M&M's

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1. Purpose and Scope

This document outlines the core guidelines and operating principles for the Mars M&M's US Field Sales Program. It is intended for Mars sales representatives, territory managers, key account managers, and distributor partners involved in day-to-day sales execution across the US.

The policies here apply to all orders captured through field visits, tele-sales, distributor orders, and online B2B channels. These transactions are reflected in the structured sales data used for reporting and analytics.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

2.1 Sales Representatives

- Own local store-level relationships with buyers and managers.

- Conduct store visits as per the agreed call plan and log each visit.

- Capture orders accurately, ensuring correct product codes, quantities, and pricing.

- Monitor shelf presence, secondary displays, and promotional execution for M&M's products.

- Escalate compliance issues, competitor activity, and pricing conflicts to the Territory Manager.

2.2 Territory Managers

- Define routing and visit frequency for sales reps across regions and states.
- Review weekly and monthly performance at region, state, customer, and rep levels.
- Approve local promotions within the guidelines of Mars commercial policy.
- Align store-level execution with head-office agreements owned by Key Account Managers.

2.3 Key Account Managers (KAMs)

- Manage top-to-top negotiations with national and regional retailers.
- Set annual and quarterly volume, revenue, and margin targets.
- Agree promotional calendars, display programs, and trade terms.
- Communicate commercial agreements clearly to Territory Managers and Sales Reps.

2.4 Distributors / Wholesale Partners

- Maintain sufficient inventory of M&M's products.
- Respect Mars pricing guidance where applicable.
- Share sell-in / sell-out reports periodically for reconciliation.

3. Territory Design and Call Planning

- The United States is divided into four primary regions:
  Northeast, Midwest, South, and West.
- Sales reps are assigned specific states and cities to optimize coverage and travel time.
- Recommended minimum visit frequency:
  - High-priority outlets (top 20% by sales): 2 visits per month.
  - Medium-priority outlets: 1 visit per month.
  - Low-priority outlets: 1 visit per quarter.

Each visit should be logged in the CRM or order app with retailer name, date, type of visit, and key outcomes including orders and issues.

4. Pricing and Discount Guidelines

4.1 Base List Price

- Each M&M's SKU has a national base list price in USD.
- Prices differ by pack type and size (e.g., share size, family size, singles, minis).
- Base prices are reviewed annually; changes are communicated in advance.

4.2 Discount Framework

Sales reps may apply discounts only within the following boundaries:

- Standard Case Discount:
  - Up to 3% off base price for orders meeting minimum case quantity.
- Promotional Discount:
  - Up to 10% off base price during approved promotional periods.
- Introductory Discount:
  - Up to 5% off base price for 60 days after a new SKU launch.

Any discount beyond these limits requires written approval from the Territory Manager and a documented business justification.

4.3 Prohibited Practices

The following are not allowed:

- Off-invoice discounts without system approval.

- Long-term price promises beyond the official price list and calendar.

- Retailer-specific funding commitments without documented agreement.

5. Trade Terms and Operational Policies

5.1 Payment Terms

- Standard terms: Net 30 days from invoice date, unless specified otherwise in a signed contract.

- Distributor partners follow the terms outlined in their Master Distribution Agreement.

5.2 Returns and Damages

- Short-dated or damaged stock can only be returned with prior authorization.

- Credit is issued after verification of product condition and quantities.

- Over-ordering by the customer without Mars error is typically not fully credited.

5.3 Promotional Support and Displays

- Off-shelf displays (end caps, dump bins, seasonal displays) must have:

  - Defined start and end dates.

  - A clear promotional mechanic (price-off, multi-buy, bundle, seasonal).

  - Written confirmation or signed promotional form.

5.4 Confidentiality and Data Use

- Pricing, discount structures, and contract terms are confidential.

- Sales data must only be used internally for analytics, planning, and performance management.

- Any external sharing requires appropriate approvals.

6. Compliance

All parties involved in the Mars M&M's US Field Sales Program must:

- Comply with applicable national and state regulations.
- Follow Mars internal codes of conduct and ethical standards.
- Respect data privacy and confidentiality rules for customers and consumers.